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“Attitude Decides Altitude”

What was the problem you were grappling with?

During my long stint with an MNC, I was in the corporate office, successfully leading a large functional role across India. I was recognised as a high-performing member, but started feeling restless as I was looking for a chance to advance to the next grade. But that role did not have a straight path for promotion. The learning curve was limited as well.

Whom did you approach for advice and why?

I reached out to my boss (then Vice President Vikas Chawla) to seek guidance. He assured that the organisation sees high potential in me and said, “roles are graded, not individuals”. He also immediately set up a meeting with (Atul Singh) then Chairman, Asia Pacific, given his broader global organisational perspective and experience.

What was the advice you received?

The pieces of advice I received were (a) ‘Attitude determines Altitude.’ Have a positive attitude and evaluate the roles, and (b) invest in yourself through learning new skills and experiences that will set you

up for success. Both mentors advised me to evaluate how similar roles and territories were graded globally within the organisation and suggested focussing on the complexity and scale of the role.

How effective was it in resolving the problem?

The advice was highly effective. Through this approach, we re-evaluated the grading of territories, which led to an upgrade for all similar roles in India. It ultimately benefitted the entire organisation by establishing role-focussed grading practices. Personally, it set a mantra for life: Don’t have FOMO (Fear of Missing Out) but FOBO (Fear of Being Obsolete). I extend the same advice to aspiring young leaders: focus on learning and upskilling to be future-ready. **BT**

—TEAM BT

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